

STATE OF NEW YORK

7833--A

2025-2026 Regular Sessions

IN ASSEMBLY

April 11, 2025

Introduced by M. of A. LEVENBERG, BURDICK, SLATER, SANTABARBARA, COLTON, STECK, KAY, DE LOS SANTOS -- read once and referred to the Committee on Social Services -- reported and referred to the Committee on Ways and Means -- recommitted to the Committee on Ways and Means in accordance with Assembly Rule 3, sec. 2 -- committee discharged, bill amended, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee

AN ACT to amend the social services law, in relation to providing panic buttons to certain employees of city and county social services districts

The People of the State of New York, represented in Senate and Assembly, do enact as follows:

Section 1. The social services law is amended by adding a new section 63 to read as follows:

§ 63. Workplace safety equipment for social services employees. 1. Every city or county social services district, as constituted by section sixty-one of this title, shall be required to provide a panic button to each employee whose job responsibilities necessitate direct interaction with clients in a client's home.

2. Such panic button shall be a wearable or mobile phone-based button. Mobile phone-based panic buttons may only be installed on employer-provided equipment, and wearable and mobile phone-based panic buttons shall not be used to track employee locations except when the panic button is triggered. Employees shall bear no cost for this equipment.

3. For the purposes of this section, "panic button" shall mean a physical or virtual button that when activated immediately initiates an emergency response by contacting either the local 9-1-1 public safety answering point ("PSAP") or a dedicated monitoring or security service that is capable of promptly notifying the PSAP. Such panic button shall provide employee location information, and result in the dispatch of local law enforcement or emergency services to the employee's location.

EXPLANATION--Matter in italics (underscored) is new; matter in brackets [-] is old law to be omitted.

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1 4. Every city or county social services district shall develop a plan
2 to ensure that employees working in areas where panic button functional-
3 ity may be limited or unavailable can receive timely assistance from
4 local law enforcement in the event of an emergency.

5 5. The commissioner of the office of children and family services
6 shall promulgate rules and regulations necessary to implement the
7 provisions of this section.

8 § 2. This act shall take effect one year after it shall have become a
9 law.